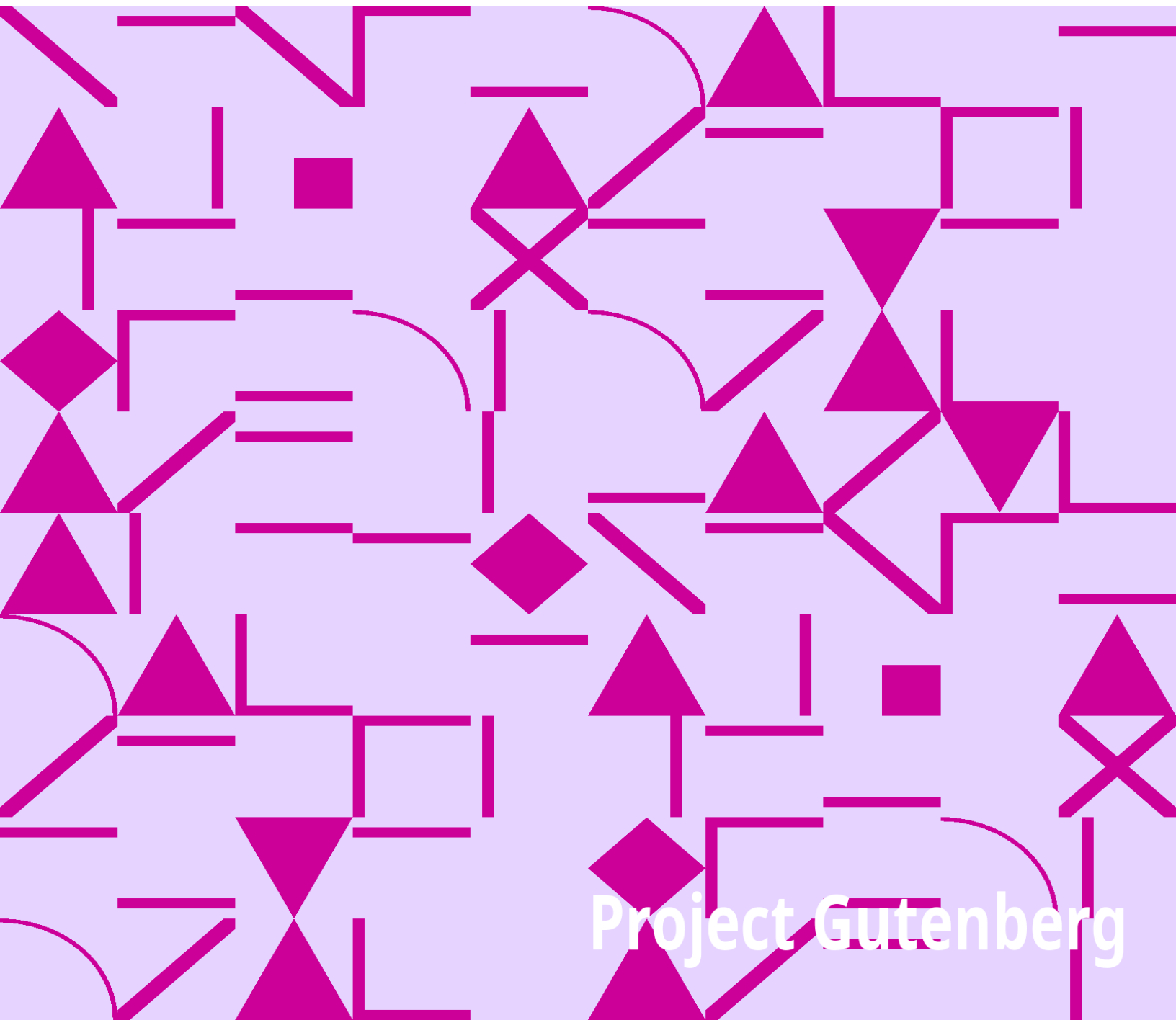


# Memorial Day, and Other Verse (Original and Translated)

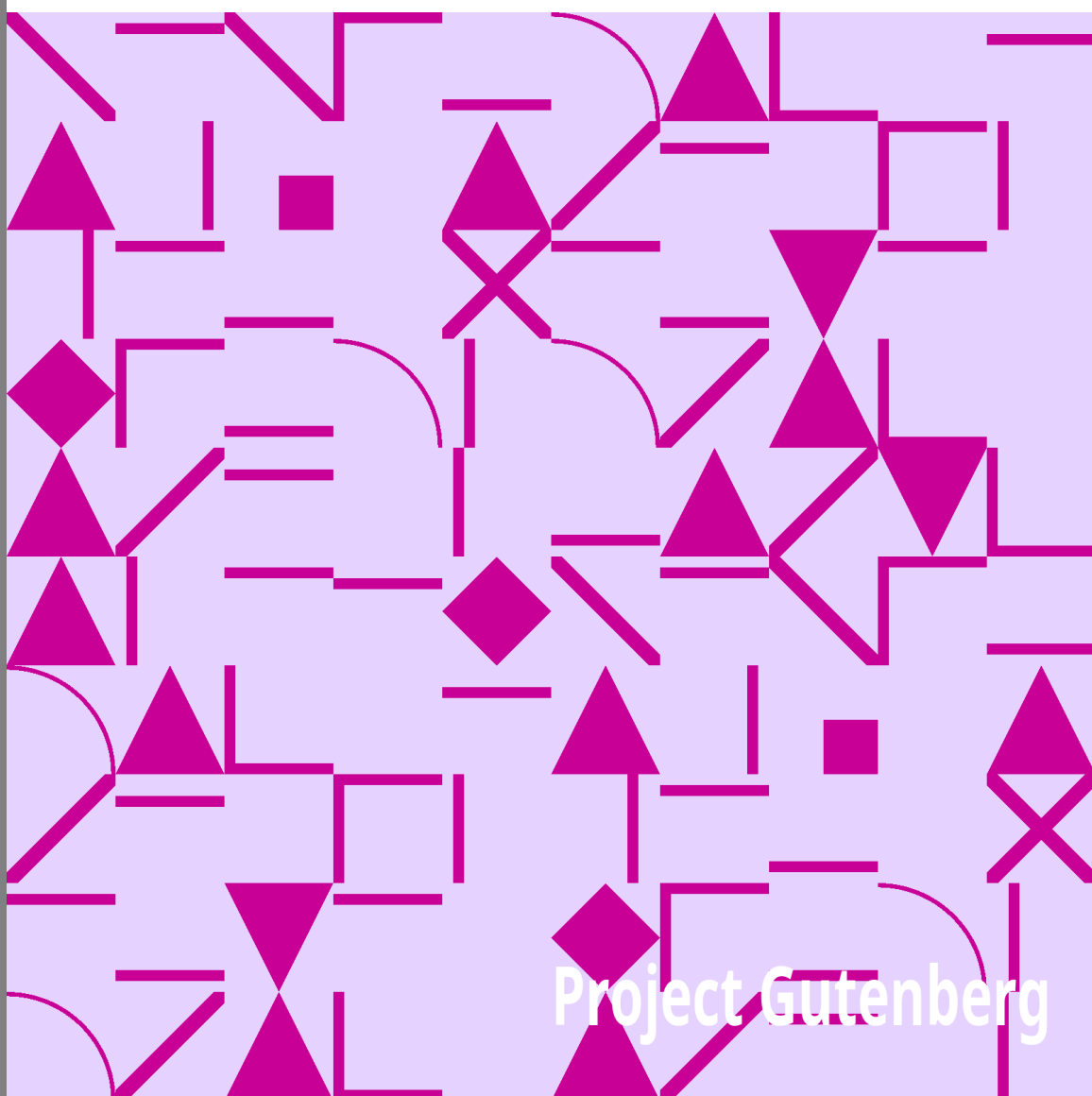
Helen Leah Reed



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# Memorial Day, and Other Verse (Original and Translated)

Helen Leah Reed



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# MEMORIAL DAY

# AND OTHER VERSE

(ORIGINAL AND TRANSLATED)

BY

HELEN LEAH REED

AUTHOR OF SERBIA; A SKETCH  
NAPOLEON'S YOUNG NEIGHBOR  
THE BRENDA SERIES, ETC.

DE WOLFE AND FISKE CO.  
20 FRANKLIN ST.  
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*This book is sold for the benefit of work for blinded soldiers*

THE·PLIMPTON·PRESS  
NORWOOD·MASS·U·S·A

TO THE MEMORY OF

# THOMAS WENTWORTH HIGGINSON

SOLDIER, SCHOLAR, FRIEND

---

The author thanks the editors of the following publications for the right to reprint certain poems of hers that they first published:

*Scribner's Magazine*, Horace III-29. *Collier's Weekly*, Horace I-14. *Poet Lore*, Horace I-11. *Chicago InterOcean*, The Fading Vision. *The Christian Union*, Jack Frost and the Flowers. *New York Sun*, The Rivals. *Metropolitan Magazine*, Strength Renewed. *Christian Endeavor World*, Town and Country. *Boston Transcript*, Summer in London; His Monument; Memorial Day. *Boston Herald*, The Cry of the Women. *Ladies' Home Journal*, The Christmas Letter. *Woman's Home Companion*, Frightened. *The Delineator*, The Victim; A Modern Grandmother. *The Youth's Companion*, A Curiosity.

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## PATRIOTIC AND SERIOUS

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### *MEMORIAL DAY*

No warrior he, a village lad,  
    needing nor words nor other prod  
To point his duty; he was glad  
    to tread the path his fathers trod.  
Week days he worked in wood and field;



with homely joys he decked his life;  
The sword of hate he would not wield,  
nor take a part in cankering strife.  
On Sunday in the little choir  
he sang of Peace and brotherly love,  
And as his thoughts soared higher and higher,  
they reached unmeasured heights above.

A cry for Freedom rent the Land—  
"Our Country calls, come, come, 'tis War;  
Together let us firmly stand;"  
he answered, though his heart beat sore  
At leaving home, and kin, and one  
in whose fond eyes too late he read  
That life for her had but begun  
with the farewells he sadly said.

A half a century has passed—  
and more—since all those myriads fell;  
For he was one of those who cast  
sweet life into a Battle's hell.  
The village has become a town,  
brick buildings the old graveyard gird;  
Of him who fought not for renown,  
no one now hears a spoken word,  
But on the Monument his name  
in gold is lettered with the rest.  
Without a sordid thought of fame  
he to his Country gave his best.

Strew flowers, then, Memorial Day  
for him, for all who for us fought.  
With speech and music honors pay;  
teach what our brave defenders taught.  
And now our sons are setting out;  
the call for Right rings to the sky,

"Our Country! Freedom!" hear them shout,  
re-echoing their Grandsires' cry.

---

## *FLOWERS FOR BRAVE SOLDIERS*

Flowers for brave soldiers,  
Flowers for those who gave us  
A Country undivided.  
Flowers for the dead!

With flags we are marking  
Their last earth-dwelling.  
Our hearts are bending  
In gratitude,  
While we are praying  
That this our Nation  
Pass safe through peril,  
Through deadly war.

Flowers for brave soldiers—  
Flowers for those who loved us,  
Flowers to their memory,  
This fair spring day!

---

## *HIS MONUMENT*

From top to pedestal you scan it lightly—  
Capped head to lettered base—and you are smiling.

What see you there to set your lips a-quiver?  
An awkward figure cut from ugly granite,  
Aye, roughly hewn, as if unhelped by chisel,  
This peaceful man of war, sculptured grotesquely.  
Still—there is metal in the gun he is holding,  
And in the cannon balls piled up before him—  
The artist's symbols of a real soldier.  
Yet jeer no longer!  
Before you is a soldier of the Union,  
Crowned with the tears and prayers of many mourners.  
The Village set him here for all to honor,  
Here, in the centre of their foot-worn common,  
Where on long, summer evenings boys at baseball  
May gaze and gaze, and make him an example;  
A hero they would follow.  
Beholding him I see no granite figure,  
But face a man who fought to save his country,  
Whose heart was pierced when wife, and child and mother  
Clung to him closely in that tearful parting.  
Yet brave he marched away while flags were fluttering,  
Though in his soul he knew that never, never,  
Might he again see those he loved so dearly,  
Nor look again upon the old white steeple,  
Upon the little streets and shabby buildings  
Straggling unevenly toward the Common;  
Or if he came back, he'd be maimed and battered,  
Subject to hateful pity.  
Therefore I smile not at the queer, gaunt figure,  
The tilted cap—the wide and baggy trousers,  
The long loose overcoat, the dangling knapsack,  
This is the man who fought to save our country!  
Who, in his millions, marched from every village,  
From every city of our mighty Nation;  
Who heard the drums and trumpets blithely playing—  
"Tramp, tramp, tramp, the boys are marching."  
So there it stands—thank-offering of a people—  
Whether of rough-hewn stone, or bronze, or marble—

Proving our debt to those who saved the Union,  
Pointing the way for those who'd like to follow—  
Who to the death would fight were we in peril—  
The Soldier's Monument!

---

## *YOUR COUNTRY AND MINE*

Sing of America, sing of our Country!  
Land of two oceans, of palm-tree and pine!  
Firm as the rock of her towering mountains,  
Free as her rivers from Heaven-born fountains,  
Unafraid as her eagle,—as true to the line;  
Sing of our Country,—your Country and mine!  
Sing of America,—self-governed Country!  
Dear Land, thou to tyranny never wilt bow;  
Ever with thee the oppressed have had haven;  
While Freedom droops, thy true sons are not craven;  
Look! They are fighting to honor thee now,  
With Victory and Peace to bejewel thy brow.  
Sing of America,—loving humanity!  
"Avenge ye the slaughtered!" Heed ye her decree;  
Ye who have reaped of the father's brave sowing,  
High hold your flag when the war winds are blowing!  
Safe for all men keep the path of the sea;  
Secure in their rights help small Nations to be.  
Fight for America, noble America!  
Liberty, Justice, and Truth—the divine,—  
Carrying onward,—her lamp proudly burning—  
Craving no empire, intrigue ever spurning,  
Over the Earth shall her beacon-light shine!  
Fight for our Country, your Country and mine!

---

## *THE GRAND ARMY PASSES*

Behold a long procession passing proudly,  
And yet no glittering pomp adorns its way,  
Only the emblems of our States and Nation,  
Only the flags that floated on the day  
These men, our men, trod upon fields of glory;—  
The tattered flags that this Grand Army bore  
For the Republic—flags that furled and faded  
To their old vividness our hearts restore.  
The line of veterans once firm and crowded,  
The long, long line is wavering and thin;  
With faltering steps Old Age speaks mutely to them  
Youth marched abreast when they were mustered in.

Oh, Comrades of the Campfire and the Council,  
Oh, Comrades who in peril won your fight!  
Honor to you and to your dead companions,  
You risked your all for Liberty and Right!  
Fraternity and Charity your watchwords,  
And Loyalty to this our own dear Land!  
Our flag you have, the brazen star, the eagle  
Undying symbols for your gallant band.  
Look at them, youths and maidens, as they pass you,  
While old-time war-tunes break upon the air,  
And staring crowds applaud; read ye the message  
That from the past these veterans nobly bear,  
"Our gift—the gift of Freedom to the Nation,  
Our great Republic would entrust to you,  
Cherish it fondly, keeping it untarnished,  
That, in the Future, looming on our view,  
You with the World may share your gift of Freedom."

This is the message that our youth must con,

While the Grand Army, answering its last roll-call  
And laying down life's weapons, passes on.

---

## *THE HARVARD REGIMENT*

We saw the Regiment, alert and strong,  
In marching line, on Soldiers' Field today,  
Ah! ready they to battle with the wrong;—  
This flower of youth—eager and brave and gay.

And we, on-looking, cheered them as they passed,  
And we, down-hearted, prayed a silent prayer,  
Gazing upon them with a grim forecast,  
And many a sad-eyed mother watched them there.

Proudly they turned, and at attention stood,  
Or shouldered arms while war-like music thrilled.  
"Alas!" we listened in unhappy mood!  
"Why should these boys in martial ways be skilled?"

No comfort for our grieving was revealed,  
Until we looked across the valiant line  
To the old College, far beyond this Field  
That honors men who fell at Freedom's shrine.

"Oh, ancient College, that so long hast bred  
Son after son to heed his Country's call.  
The answer to our questionings is read—  
In yonder Tower of your Memorial Hall."

---

## *SUMMER IN LONDON*

Oh, the noise of Piccadilly—its rumble and its roar!  
A tide of life's broad ocean surging toward the shore.  
Who once has listened, ever can hear its long refrain  
With haunting echo drowning or dirge or flaunting strain.  
Who heeds it, in his vision may see a world-throng pass—  
And over there the Green Park with laughing lad and lass;  
While weary men and women and careless youth go by,  
Where windows glow and glitter, and in the evening sky  
A crescent moon is watching the laughing lass and lad.  
The long, warm London twilight! Happy they are, though  
sad.  
With kiss and tear they are parting. 'Tis late—the rush and  
roar—  
The life of Picadilly is waning—is no more.

Ah, the dark, the cold, the stillness of the trenches in the  
night,  
Where freezing men are crouching in the lull before the  
fight.  
Then for one the calm is broken by the rumble and the roar  
Of far-off Picadilly, and in dreams, as oft before,  
He sees her who wept at parting. What was that? A whining  
shell?  
Once a man—that huddled horror! He was smiling as he fell.

Summer has returned to London. Now the Green Park  
gleams anew.  
Cheers and tears together mingle—but the breaking heart  
beats true.  
Blare of trumpet!—blood and fire!—so her hero marched  
away.  
Happy lad and lass they parted—now the pitying sky is gray.  
Blood and fire! Through its heroes shall a nation live again.

Blare of trumpet! But in silence aching hearts must bear  
their pain.

Ah, the stillness of the trenches! ah, the rumble and the roar!  
Cheers and tears by England offered for the lads who come  
no more.

1915

---

## *SERBIA*

Serbia, valiant daughter of the Ages,  
Happiness and light should be thy portion!  
Yet thy day is dimmed, thine heart is heavy;  
Long hast thou endured—a little longer  
Bear thy burden, for a fair to-morrow  
Soon will gleam upon thy flower-spread valleys,  
Soon will brighten all thy shadowy mountains;  
Soon will sparkle on thy foaming torrents  
Rushing toward the world beyond thy rivers.  
Bulgar, Turk and Magyar long assailed thee.  
Now the Teuton's cruel hand is on thee  
Though he break thy heart and rack thy body,  
'Tis not his to crush thy lofty spirit.  
Serbia cannot die. She lives immortal,  
Serbia—all thy loyal men bring comfort  
Fighting, fighting, and thy far-flung banner  
Blazons to the world thy high endeavor,  
—This thy strife for brotherhood and freedom—  
Like an air-free bird unknowing bondage,  
Soaring far from carnage, smoke and tumult,  
Serbia—thy soul shall live forever!  
Serbia, undaunted is, immortal!



---

## *A CANADIAN TROOPER TO HIS HORSE*

Rest here, my horse, the night is dull,—the blood-sick stars  
are gone,  
Listen, for thou like me wert bred in far Saskatchewan.  
And this September night at home, under a happier sky,  
The bursting yellow sheaves upon the unbounded prairie lie.  
Bread, bread—the staff and stay of life—'tis what the  
wheatlands yield;  
But only death and agony are gathered from this field.

There's respite now, but ah! good friend, before another day,  
Although our bodies may be here, we, we, how far away!  
We've ridden many a weary mile, together we have fought  
For Freedom, honor and the right, and anything we've  
wrought  
Our Country to the Empire will still more closely bind.  
Ah! where the reddened maple leaf is fluttering in the wind,  
There is my heart, oh noble horse, and may we gallop free  
Some day again in Canada, our Land of Liberty.

The night drags on toward the dawn, and far on yonder plain  
I hear the throb of musketry, I feel its echoing pain.  
I see the star-shells breaking, and nearer than their flare,  
A wreath of deadly smoke points out that once a town was  
there.  
Look, brother horse, the night is past, and glorious is the  
dawn,  
Away with peril! We'll ride on for our Saskatchewan.  
With day comes hope, and though again the sky with blood  
is red,  
We'll ride against the enemy, for Victory lies ahead,

Aye! for the Empire—Victory that thou shalt help to bring.  
And for the Allies Victory—on earth what greater thing!

---

## *THE CRY OF THE WOMEN*

A new year dawning on a warring world!  
And many fight, and many pray for peace;  
But yet the roar of battle will not cease,  
Still man against his brother man is hurled.

So we who wait—we women in our woe,  
Who wait and work—who wait, and work, and weep—  
For us there is no rest, for us no sleep,  
As our sad thoughts are wandering grim and slow,

Across those dreary fields where far away  
Our hero myriads bleed and burn and die,  
We lift our hearts toward the pitying sky—  
Dawns there no hope upon this New Year's day?

1915

---

## *CASSANDRA*

Of all the luckless women ever born,  
Or ever to be born here on our earth,  
Most pitied be Cassandra, from her birth  
Condemned to woes unearned by her. Forlorn,  
She early read great Ilium's doom, and tried,

Clear-eyed, clear-voiced, her countrymen to warn.  
But—she Apollo's passion in high scorn  
Had once repelled, and of his injured pride  
The God for her had bred this punishment,—  
That good, or bad, all things she prophesied  
Though true as truth, should ever be decried  
And flouted by the people. As she went  
Far from old Priam's gates among the crowd,  
To save her country was her heart intent.  
Pure, fearless, on an holy errand bent,  
They called her "mad," who was a Princess proud.  
"Alas, the City falls! Beware the horse!  
Woe, woe, the Greeks!" Ah! why was she endowed  
With this sad gift? Able to pierce the cloud  
That veils the future,—in its wasting course  
She could not stop the storm. Bitter the pain  
When those she loved and trusted—weak resource—  
Her prophecies believed not; when the force  
Of all her pleading spent itself in vain.  
Poor Maid! She knew no greater agony  
When dragged a slave in Agamemnon's train.  
And though she fell—by Clytemnestra slain—  
She smiled on Death who eased her misery.  
For oh—what grief to one of faithful heart  
It is—to know the evils that must be.  
Helpless their doom to make the imperilled see,  
Unskilled to shield them from the fatal dart!

---

## *SONG OF SPRING*

On every bush are roses blooming, everywhere the  
nightingale  
To his love again is warbling plaintively his oft-told tale.

Now within our balmy garden dances the tall cypress tree,  
And the poplar never ceases clapping his slim hands in glee.  
From the height of every bough-tip you can hear the turtle  
sing,  
With loud voice proclaiming gaily the glad coming of the  
spring.  
On the head of the narcissus gleams as bright his diadem,  
As the crown of China's Emperor decked with many a costly  
gem.  
Here the west wind, there the north wind, in true token of  
their love,  
At the feet of yonder rose lay treasure poured down from  
above.  
All the earth with musk is scented, and musk-laden is the air.  
Everything proclaims that daily now draws nearer spring the  
fair.

*(Versified from a Persian paraphrase.)*

---

## *LIFE AND DEATH*

"Death after life" shall we sigh as we say it,  
Sigh as if death were the end for us all,  
Pale at the thought, as in silence we weigh it,  
Yield our dull souls to it, bending in thrall?

"Life after death"—look ahead, weakling spirit—  
Sure is the way to a world that is ours.  
Death is fruition, why then should we fear it?  
Death—the fruition of life's budding powers.

---

## *MAN OF TODAY*

For thee he thought,  
The Greek, who by the sea  
Lay in his lithe-limbed grace, as dreamily  
He gazed upon the sky begemmed with stars,  
And pondered mysteries. Ah, few the bars  
To stop that lofty spirit in its flight  
Compared with those that lock our souls in night.  
For thee he thought!  
For thee he wrought,  
The Tyrian, who of old  
His rich web wove of purple dye and gold;  
Whose little bark, outstanding many a storm,  
To ruder lands the spirit and the form  
Of Eastern culture bore. Ah! what we owe  
To him today, let sage and poet show.  
For thee he wrought!  
For thee he fought!  
The Saxon, who upheld  
The freedom of our race; whose broad-ax felled  
Imperial legions in the forest dim  
Where loud his war-cry rang—a noble hymn  
For manhood's victory over regal pride,  
On the sad day when mighty Varus died.  
For thee he fought!  
For thee He taught!  
The Nazarene who bore  
The burden of the world, who by the shore  
Of Galilee His words of wisdom spake  
Whose life a pattern for our life we'd take,  
Whose words, re-echoing to remotest time,  
Shall lead us on toward a height sublime.  
For thee He taught!  
Man—man! thou heir of all the ages, thou,

Man of today! uplift thy drooping brow!  
Think, work, fight, teach—thine heritage pass on  
Tenfold increased. He'll reap who has foregone  
Life's little, limited delights,—in measure  
As selfless he has sown his earthly treasure.

---

## *THE FADING VISION*

The vision fades—dome, pinnacle and tower,  
All the white beauty of the lake-side dream,  
The artist's ideal, the poet's theme  
Vanish away. Yet for no fleeting hour

Was this proud fabric raised. The crumbling wall  
Entombs not memory's treasure, and we hold  
This truth dear as the miser his loved gold,  
Dome, pinnacle and tower cannot fall.

No marvel this, that memory holds fast  
Such beauty, passing beauty seen before,  
The grace and charm of every clime and shore,  
Strength of today, the glories of the past,

All met in one great whole—for not alone  
Man's hand the wonder wrought, but soaring high  
His spirit, like the bird that cleaves the sky,  
Knew naught of obstacle from zone to zone.

Deathless his work. Age shall repeat to age  
The story of the city by the Lake.  
And as the waves that on the near sands break  
Reach far-off shores, so on the pictured page

Throughout remotest time, serene in pride,  
Wearing her crown of glory, shall be seen  
Stately and fair, Chicago, Western queen,  
With all the Nations gathered at her side.

Gladly they met, each teaching and each taught,  
Light-skinned or dark-skinned from the West or East.  
Peoples unlike, as at a loving feast,  
Distant no more, united in a thought.

Columbia! this thy lesson, learn it well—  
The comity of Nations; this the plan  
Of God from time's first dawn, that man with man,  
Bound in one brotherhood in peace should dwell.

Great Voyager, whose caravels outsped  
Man's swiftest fancy in those earlier days!  
If, looking far beyond the curving bays  
Of this new world thy glowing spirit read

That here there stretched a mighty continent  
Where a sure haven for mankind should be,  
Small didst thou count thy peril on the sea,  
Well knowing what thy sufferings had meant.

For it was thine to turn toward the West  
The worn old-world, and westward as the star  
Of Power moves, nor tyranny nor war  
Its fires sustains—it shines for the oppressed.

The vision fades—dome, pinnacle and tower—  
Yet fades not like the substance of a dream—  
Nation to Nation, State to State shall seem  
Drawn to each other closer through its power.

## *THE TITANIC*

Out of the misty North  
    A stealthy foeman stole;  
    Far from the haunted Pole  
On the wide sea went he forth,

And he met a giant ship  
    As he scoured the sea for toll  
    It cannot reach its goal  
Crushed in his icy grip.

"Of every four just three"  
    This was his deadly dole.  
    Unseen he called the roll  
Ah! a cold grave is the Sea.

Yet the Sea is not the end,  
    And Life is not the whole.  
    Over each heroic soul  
Shall Eternity extend.

---

## *IF LOVE WERE ALL*

If Love were all, how dark the world!  
    What sorrow for the stricken heart!  
        If Love were all, with Love grown cold—  
        No tempest raging bleak and bold,  
Its icy fury ever hurled  
    As madly as the storms that dart  
        Across the soul when Love is dead.



Poor soul, on bitter passion fed,  
Seeing in Earth or Heaven—no bliss,  
When Love has died in Love's last kiss.  
If Love were all!

If Love were all, how fair the earth!  
What joy in every heart-throb here!  
If Love were all, and Love were kind,  
Love's message, blown on every wind,  
Thrilling the soul, would give small worth  
To cringing caution, or the jeer  
Of those who murmur "Love must die"  
When Love's alight from eye to eye,  
Life is a happy holiday.  
"Where's Winter?" Ah, 'twere ever May,  
If Love were all!

---

## *THE ROVER*

That it be love, I dare not say,  
I only know when he's away,  
Dark as the night, so dark the day.

But still he'll rove, and still I'll try  
Some light to see in yon grim sky.

For I will prove if power there be  
To lead him through the night to me  
In that soul-star,—fair Constancy.

---

## *AH! LITTLE LAKE*

Ah! little lake, though fair thou art,  
A sapphire flashing to the sky,  
Thy charm is only for the eye,  
Thy beauty cannot hold my heart.

Green hill-sides bending to thy shore  
Gleam clear in the autumnal light,  
While far above, Monadnock's height  
Keeps rugged guard thy waters o'er.

And yet these very beauties cloy;  
As in a prison I am bound,  
Though fair the walls that gird me round,  
My housemate is no longer joy.

Thy loveliness breeds discontent,  
For far my foolish heart would be,  
It longs for the unquiet sea,  
And with desire is sorely rent.

Hateful the walls that me debar  
From happier things that haunt me so,  
Even my weary thoughts are slow  
To reach the great, great world afar.

I half believe there is no world  
Those cruel hill-tops there beyond.  
Oh—for the wizard Merlin's wand!  
That all these mountain curves uncurled.

I might behold the shore I love,  
Might hear the roaring of the tide,  
Might see the ocean, reaching wide

And boundless as the sky above.

One hour beside that sea-kissed beach  
Quick throbbing to its love's caress,  
Would yield to me more happiness  
Than a whole life-time here could teach.

---

## *SEVERUS SPEAKS*

"For nearly eighteen years upon my head  
The crown of Empire heavily has set.  
The burden on my shoulders I have borne  
Of an estate encumbered far and wide  
With debts I had to pay. Ah! everywhere  
Murmurs, revolts, or wars assailed my throne.  
Now quiet comes—even in Britain here,  
The most disturbing Province of them all.  
Yet I must go, the profits I must leave  
To others to enjoy—to hold with ease  
What I with bitter travail have obtained.  
Peace there must be, and mutual amity,  
The one support to hold the Empire firm,  
To keep the Glory of the Empire bright.  
Discord would be the ruin of the pile,  
That my poor hands have built so painfully.  
Only when Peace prevails may we behold  
How small things grow to greatness.

—Now I die

And all the issue of the coming days  
I leave to my successor, and my son,  
Though he has been a cruel son to me.  
Bassanius I name your Emperor,  
The new-made Antoninus, who long tried

To get that title by the sword,  
Who sought my death, the dangers knowing not  
That always must surround a diadem,  
Forgetting that the places of the great  
Are guarded well by Envy and by Fear.  
Blind is ambition, for it cannot see  
That though a sovereign's power large may seem  
To others, by himself the things possessed  
Are counted small enough, aye small they *are*.  
For titles cannot make a happy man.  
While his thin thread of life must waver so,  
His might is laid upon a weak support.  
So men may point to me, and say 'Behold—  
A man who once was all things in this world,  
Yet now is nothing. For like meaner men  
He paid his debt to nature. His exploits  
He left behind.' Aye, friends I leave my deeds  
For you to register. Reproach or praise  
The shadowing pencil of oblivion  
At last will blot. And yet that all the care  
That I have taken for the general good  
May bring forth happy fruits when I am dust,  
This would I make my one, my last request,  
—Assist my sons with counsel and with aid,  
That they may rule according to the law,  
And you obey according to the right.  
So, through you both—my legions and my sons—  
The Empire shall be held in high respect."

And then the dying Emperor feebly turned  
Toward the urn wherein so soon must lie  
His ashes—and he cried "So shalt thou hold  
What the whole world one time could not contain."  
Thus died Severus.

---

## *TOWN AND COUNTRY*

About the country they may talk who will,  
Who praise it ever to the town's despite.  
Let him extol the charms of wood and hill  
Who finds them peerless. None disputes his right.

For me the town! Each well-worn footway old  
To me is dearer than your grass-grown lane.  
Not all who struggle here contend for gold;  
Green-growing things quit not the soul of pain.

"God made the country." Ay, and God made man.  
Working through man His power He displays,  
And in the city's mazes His great plan  
Is writ as clear as in calm country ways.

---

## *STRENGTH RENEWED*

Antæus, as the ancient poets sing,  
Though in his contest with the God of Power  
Doomed to be conquered, stayed the fatal hour,  
And the onlookers set to wondering.  
For overborne, to Earth he'd closely cling,  
Until he rose again, a mighty tower.  
Thus could the Earth with strength her lover dower,  
And very near to victory could bring.  
So when I feel thy tender hand in mine,  
I, too, dear love, against the world could stand,  
Courage divine comes with thy lightest touch.  
Afar from thee Antæus-like I pine,

But strength returns now as I clasp thy hand.  
Ah! that so slight a thing should mean so much.

---

## *AT MIAMI*

Here, where the proud hibiscus blooms in flame,  
Where swaying palms nod lightly to the sea,  
Where each azalea towers—a stately tree—  
And orange blossoms charm, today I came  
Upon a little flower unknown to fame,  
Half hid in the scant sward, white as this shell  
From yonder beach, and I can hardly tell  
What drew me to it, murmuring its name.

"Bred in cool meadows, vagrant from the North,  
Fair Dewberry, what art thou doing here?  
Or chance, or purpose started thee to roam?  
And yet whatever power sent thee forth,  
Still it is thine to call the sudden tear,  
To stir the trembling heart with thoughts of home."

---

## *WHICH*

Who then is rich, who poor? I'll tell you now  
Of one, a meagre life who had to live,  
Wear dingy garb, and scarcely could allow  
Himself what men call comfort; yet to give  
Was his delight,—to give full-heartedly.

Though Fate had hampered him, he always knew  
Some one still poorer. In humility  
He thus gave hope to him who had small view  
Of happier things;—solace to him who wept;—  
And to the beaten courage to endure.  
He shared his little with the starved, and kept  
His best for those who needed most. Though poor,  
By giving he grew richer day by day  
In all that brightens life's uncertain way.

There was another who had never known  
A wish unsatisfied. For everything  
That luxury could offer was his own.  
Thus all that learning, all that wealth could bring  
Adorned his life. The many him would praise,—  
For this world loves the prosperous,—and still  
Close to himself he hugged his all. To raise  
A helping hand he never had the will.  
He never heard the cries of men in need.  
Of all he had he would not give a part.  
For "I" and "mine" was ever his one creed.  
No balm had he for any aching heart.  
Mean was his life (as was the other's great)  
Despite the splendor of his high estate.  
And now in yonder world I wonder which—  
For both are dead—is counted poor—or rich.

---

## *THE BLESSED DEAD*

They loved life, even as we, who went away  
From their dear dwelling-place to one unknown  
To us who linger here. They could not stay,  
Nor we go with them, so they went alone.

Although their beating hearts with ours kept time,  
Although their clinging hands we fondly held,  
We could not walk the path they had to climb,  
Hardly we heard the death-call when it knelled.

Trustful, or fearful of the way ahead,  
They had to journey from this throbbing life,  
And we—we know they are the blessed dead,  
For they have gone away from pain and strife.

We cannot see the land where they have gone.  
Our eyes are dim, and they are hid in light,  
But we are following them toward the dawn,  
Who knows when it will break upon our sight!

---

## *OAK-LEAVES*

Crinkled oak-leaves, twinkling in the sun,  
Splashed by midday showers, dripping cold—  
Serrate oak-leaves, silvered by the sun  
That has brushed yon dull brown grass with gold.

Green and crinkled oak leaves, tremble now—  
Strong you would be, strong would be and bold,  
Ah! green oak-leaves, you are trembling now—  
By the saucy wind deceived—cajoled!

Trembling oak leaves—you are soon to fall,  
Soon to hide the earth with yellowing mould  
Twinkling, crinkling oak-leaves, soon you'll fall  
For the autumn sun is shining cold.



---

## *SELF-SATISFIED*

Well satisfied with all his own, he stands  
Holding a trembling balance in his hands;  
On one scale—wealth and ease, men's praises, too—  
Whatever charms the soul, and keeps it true.  
But on the other scale—lo—the foul street  
Where pallid children play, where poor folk greet,  
And crowded houses dirty, dimly lit,  
On whose dull walls all misery is writ,  
Houses wherein the herded cannot fight  
The ambushed evil lurking day and night.  
Has he—contented one—who counts his gain,  
Balanced the cost—the wretchedness and pain  
Of those who help him hoard his heap of gold?  
Ah, human life may be too dearly sold!  
For see, the one scale weighs the other down.  
His gold, his ease, his honors—by Heaven's frown  
Withered to nothing, now, behold he stands—  
Broken his scales—reaching imploring hands.

---

## *MY VIGIL*

Companioned by the lonely hours,  
My vigil with the stars I keep,—  
The happy stars that never weep,—  
The wakeful stars that never sleep,  
Spirit of me that frets and cowers,  
Ah, what am I, that I should be

And breathe in this Infinity?

Unburdened of the weight of self,  
Toward the highest heights I am borne,  
Below lies Earth, begrimed and worn,  
Far, far from me her praise, her scorn,  
Her joys, her woes, her loss, her pelf,  
One with the happy stars am I!  
Our limits the unbounded sky!

---

## *TO MRS. JULIA WARD HOWE*

Dear Lady of Tranquillity, Ah! lightly have the years  
Their music on thy heart-strings played, and all the smiles  
and tears  
That mark the joy of living, that sound the depths of pain  
For thee make one great harmony—a happy heart's refrain.

*(On her eighty-sixth birthday.)*

---

## *THE SOARER*

There soars a warbler toward high Heaven,  
His course seems sure and straight;—  
So speeds an arrow from the bow-string,  
Yet who can read his fate!

For while he carols like a seraph  
Bound for a radiant star

Mayhap the fowler's eye, relentless,  
Has doomed him from afar.

A longer life the crawling snail hath  
Than thou—O wanderer bright—  
Ah, let the sluggard crawl in safety,  
Thine is the realm of light!

Like thee a soaring soul's in peril,  
Yet its one hour is worth  
A whole Eternity of grovelling  
Closer to grimy earth.

---

## *A FANCY*

The world of dreams is all my own,  
Wherein I wander—free, alone;—  
And each weird, fervid fantasy  
Is dearer than earth's joys to me.  
The waking world I share with you;  
And yours, as mine, is the ocean's blue.  
For us both spring's early flowers are fair,  
Or the cold stars gleam through the frosty air.

But in the world of dreams I rove  
Over sunny fields, or in shaded grove,—  
Such beauty your eyes never saw—  
And all is mine without let or law.  
Ah! the hopes and fears that come and go  
With my flying fancy, none may know;  
Though unsubstantial, it seems  
My real world—this world of dreams.

---

## *THE SHRIEKING WOMAN AT MARBLEHEAD*

'Twas a Spanish galleon sailed the seas,—  
Two centuries since have rolled—  
Laden with silver and gems to please  
Gay dames and gallants bold.

But villainous pirates seized the ship  
As homeward she was bound;  
Ah, she has made her last long trip  
For they ran her soon aground.

From Oakum Bay into Marblehead  
They brought one lady fair,—  
Her husband, alas, and his crew are dead,  
And her they will not spare.

Loud, loud she shrieked in the pirates' arms,  
"Oh, save me—Jesu, save!"  
Cruel echo mocked at her wild alarms,  
As they dug her a nameless grave.

Yet once a year when the night has come  
That saw her dreadful death,  
You can hear her above the ocean's boom  
Shriek out with her dying breath.

---

## *THE HUGUENOT LOVERS*

Sorrowful pleading on her face is written  
With love commingled, and my heart throbs fast,  
Flooded with currents of a deep emotion  
Stirred by the memory of that awful past.  
Note the sad gaze of him who bends above her,  
What say his eyes in answer to her own?  
What did he think as tenderly he kissed her?  
What was the meaning of his whispered tone?  
Spoke he of honor's claim poor love's outweighing,  
Or did her circling arms so well enfold  
That the white kerchief wearing-badge of safety—  
He passed the lurking foe with spirit bold.

Ah, they are vanished now—the maid and lover,  
Their history the wisest cannot tell.  
Mayhap upon that night of cruel slaughter,  
Eager to meet the zealot's hate he fell.  
Mayhap in some fair corner of the Kingdom,  
Under the gentler rule of brave Navarre,  
They showed the kerchief to their children's children,  
And told the story of the unholy war.

---

## *TO JOHN TOWNSEND TROWBRIDGE*

Gay Summer sees the flowering  
Of buds that were the gift of Spring;  
And Winter counts the ripened sheaves  
That Autumn harvested. Who grieves  
When he at length has won the race,  
Or backward then his way would trace?

Oh, honored Poet, Wit, and Sage,  
This birthday marks an open page,  
And here before its record's writ,  
These words we would inscribe on it.  
"Thou, upon whom thy years fourscore  
So lightly sit, thou hast a store  
Of memories such as they alone  
May have whose hearts all truth have known.  
Now may this year bring thee no less  
Than all the past of happiness!"

*(On his eightieth birthday.)*

---

## *WEED OR FLOWER*

"'Tis but a common thing," one coldly said,  
"Nay, call it not a flower—this little weed,  
If plucking it, I kill it, root and seed—  
Better the world were if it lay there dead."

"Ah—rather let it live!" a second cried,  
"Weed it may be, and yet it has its use,  
Here in its healing essence its excuse  
For blooming lies, and here its only pride."

"Destroy it not!" another pled, "Behold  
This tapering leaf—this soft and tender green,  
Upon my canvas it shall bloom serene—  
This tiny chalice-fleck of living gold."

Then one bent over it, "Ah, flowret bright!  
For only flowers in this garden grow,—

His earth, His sunshine made thee, o'er thee blow  
His winds, frail thing! In thee He shows His might."

---

*THOMAS WENTWORTH HIGGINSON*  
*(IN MEMORY)*

Sage of the silver pen!  
Wherever thy thought was heard,  
Thou wert a leader of men.  
Poet of honored word!  
Knight of the eagle glance,  
Piercing the depths of wrong,  
"Justice" thy cry, and thy lance  
True in its aim, and strong.

Man of the ruddy heart  
Beating warm for our kind!  
Thine was the hero's part;  
Eyes wert thou to the blind:  
Thou a staff to the weak,  
Here we our tribute lay—  
Homage thou didst not seek—  
Twined with a wreath of bay,  
A garland woven of love,  
Woven of love and tears,  
Pure as the note of a dove,  
Voicing thy peaceful years.

*(Read at the Memorial Meeting Nov. 20, 1911.)*

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## LIGHTER VERSE

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### *FRIGHTENED*

Today I had the awfulest time,  
Dear mother, in the wood.  
That hill out there we were to climb,  
And we'd been very good.  
But nurse was walking up the hill,  
When little Anne and I,  
We had to stop and stand quite still,  
And Anne began to cry.

For something moved behind the trees,  
We felt so all alone—  
Said I to Anne, "Stop crying, please,  
I'll hit it with a stone."  
Cried Anne, "Oh, listen, hear it growl."  
Said I, "I'm not afraid  
Of bears or lions." "Now don't scowl.  
You look so cross," she said.  
So then I had to smile and smile, for Anne was crying all the  
while.  
And if we didn't *hear* a bear, I'm sure, dear mother, one was  
there.

Boys always must take care of girls,  
You see you've told me so.  
That's why I tried to pat Anne's curls,  
And walked with her real slow.  
But when we heard nurse calling out,  
"Come, children, come along!"



"Come, Nurse," you should have heard me shout—  
Anne says my voice is strong.  
"Run, Anne," I cried, "I'm almost five, and I'll kill any bear  
alive."  
And if we didn't *see* a bear, I truly think that one was there.

How glad I was when Nurse turn'd round,  
For everything seemed queer.  
The trees looked strange, and then that sound  
We didn't like to hear.  
Nurse laughed when we had told her all  
About the bear we saw.  
"I came as quick's I heard you call,  
And it's against the law  
For bears to live where people stay. They are five hundred  
miles away."  
But if we didn't *meet* a bear, I'm sure that *almost* one was  
there.

---

## *THE CHRISTMAS LETTER*

I'm always glad when Christmas comes, and yet I'd like it  
better;  
If mother wouldn't bother me to write a Christmas letter  
To uncle John and Cousin Kate and dear old Grand-aunt  
Gray,  
And all whose presents come to me from places far away.  
Of course I love my presents, and if givers should forget her,  
No little girl, my mother says, need write a Christmas letter.  
For oh! my ink makes awful blots, though I try to do real  
well,  
And when you write them out of school, all words are hard  
to spell.

I mean to mind my mother, she's so kind I would not fret  
her,  
But when she says, "Stop playing, dear. Come, write this  
Christmas letter,"  
That's just the thing I hate to hear, and if I dared, I wouldn't  
Remember how to hold a pen, I'd make believe I couldn't.

---

## *A VICTIM*

My Auntie has a camera, and when I'm out at play  
And see her coming with it, I try to hide away.  
For oh, it is so bothersome to hear her, with a laugh,  
Call, "Stand just where you are, dear; I'll take a photograph."

Sometimes, an angry lion, I have just begun to roar,  
And all the children run from me to sneak behind the door,  
When Auntie to our forest comes—why does she stop our  
fun?  
I'd like to shoot that camera there with my wooden gun.

Perhaps, a fire engine, I am rushing to a fire,  
While people loudly call for help as flames rise higher and  
higher.  
I hurry toward the hydrant here, for oh! the flames are hot!  
When Auntie with her camera cries, "What a fine snapshot!"

But then it doesn't seem to snap, so I must be polite,  
And when she says, "Oh please, stand still, the sun is not  
just right,"  
I have to pull up where I am, and see that house burn down,  
For Auntie doesn't understand, even when I twist and frown.

She only says, "Don't squirm, my pet! Oh, what a cunning

pose!

Your scowl is better than a smile,"—so that's the way it goes

—

A p'liceman or an admiral, no matter what I am,

I have to face that camera as quiet as a lamb.

---

## *JACK FROST*

Oh! it is little Margery who has a garden-bed,  
Wherein grow purple pansies and geraniums white and red,  
With feverfew and dahlias, and delicate pink phlox,  
And grandmother's fair favorites, old-fashioned hollyhocks.

One night we feared Jack Frost might come to blight the  
tender flowers—  
We almost felt his cruel breath in the early evening hours;  
So Margery took coverings and spread them, thick and  
warm,  
To shield the flowers, as blankets wrap a sleeping baby's  
form.

Then in the morning, when we looked across the dewy  
grass,  
And saw the traces Jack Frost leaves where he is wont to  
pass—  
For each spreading tree and slender bush had felt his chill  
caress,  
And some had drooped, and some had blushed in crimson  
loveliness—

We hastened to the garden-bed, and there, in bright array,  
The little flowers looked blithely up to greet the smiling day.  
Safe hid from Jack Frost's piercing breath, he never saw

them there,  
And the flowers still bloom for Margery, to thank her for her  
care.

---

## *A CURIOSITY*

I knew a little boy, not very long ago,  
Who was as bright and happy as any boy you know.  
He had an only fault, and you will all agree  
That from a fault like this a boy himself might free.

"I wonder who is there, oh, see! now, why is this?"  
And "Oh, where are they going?" and "Tell me what it is?"  
Ah! "which" and "why" and "who," and "what" and "where"  
and "when,"  
We often wished that never need we hear those words again.

He seldom stopped to think; he almost always knew  
The answer to the questions that around the world he threw.  
To children seeking knowledge a quick reply we give,  
But answering what he asked was pouring water through a  
sieve.  
Yet you'll admit his fate was as sad as it was strange.  
Our eyes we hardly trusted, who slowly saw him change.  
More curious grew his head, stemlike his limbs, and hark!  
He was at last a mere interrogation-mark!

---

## *THE FIRST LIE*

I'm sure I did not break this cup;  
It just fell down,—I know it did—  
For I was only climbing up,  
Why do they keep the cake-box hid?—  
I wanted such a little bit!  
And then I heard that creaking door,  
I can't tell what it was I hit,  
Nor how that cup got on the floor.

The shelf it stood on was too high,  
That cup my mother loved the most!  
Oh dear! I never told a lie,  
And mother whispered, "Do not boast,"  
The day I said I never could.  
(But there's that broken cup!)—and then  
I promised that I never would—  
So—I'll not tell a lie—*again*.

---

## *THE PARASOL*

You are the loveliest parasol  
I ever saw,—and all my own,—  
What frilly frills! I feel as tall  
As mother now. Here! take my doll.  
Dolls are for children—ladies grown  
Have parasols, and fans, and rings,  
And all those pretty, shiny things.

Nurse calls you "sunshade," but I think  
That is too plain a word, for see!  
You are so satiny and pink  
And there is such a curly kink  
Here in your handle, there could be

No name too fine, I love you so,  
I'll take you everywhere I go.

Next Sunday when to church I walk,  
Above my head I'll hold you high.  
Oh! how the other girls will talk,  
And maybe some of them will mock,  
"How proud she feels," as I pass by—  
I'd hold you up, straight down the aisle,  
If only people wouldn't smile.

---

## *A MODERN GRANDMOTHER*

I want to see a grandmother like those there used to be,  
In a cosy little farm-house, where I could go to tea;  
A grandmother with spectacles and a funny, frilly cap,  
Who would make me sugar cookies, and take me on her lap,  
And tell me lots of stories of the days when she was small,  
When everything was perfect—not like today at all.

My grandmother is "grandma," and she lives in a hotel,  
And when they ask "What is his age?" she smiles and will  
not tell.

Says she doesn't care to realize that she is growing old;  
Then whispers—"But you're far too big a boy for me to  
hold."

Her dresses shine and rustle, and her hair is wavy brown,  
And she has an automobile, that she steers, herself, down  
town.

My grandmother is pretty. "Do I love her?" Rather—yes;  
Our Norah calls her stylish, and on the whole I guess  
She's better than the other kind, for once, when I was ill,

She helped my mother nurse me, and read to me until  
I fell asleep; and stayed with me, and wasn't tired, and then  
She played nine holes of golf with me when I got out again.  
Yet, because I've never seen one, just once I want to see  
A real old-fashioned grandmother, like those there used to  
be.

---

## *SIGNS FOR THE SERIOUS*

He has a taste that's superfine who flouts at every subway  
sign,  
He reckons not that some there be, who cannot tell, unless  
they see  
Spelled plain before them on the wall, what things their own  
they ought to call  
For instance, when I come to town, whom you may dub a  
country clown—  
How should I know what things to buy, if not a subway sign  
were nigh  
To show—the pills I ought to take my all-consuming thirst  
to slake;—  
The hair restorer that will soothe my infant son with his first  
tooth;—  
The ruddy catsup that is sure all family jars and ills to cure;  
—  
The dollar watch that daintily we'll serve, wound-up, for  
early tea;—  
The window-screens that will not hide our failings from the  
country-side;—  
What breakfast-food is our true friend, the dime cigars that I  
should send  
My wife to cure her racking cough. The hooks and eyes that  
won't come off

Ah! hats, and soaps, and castor-oil, and cocoa that we need  
not boil;—  
And well-made suits and patent soup, and phonographs.—  
But what a dupe  
Of every city tradesman I, if all these vendibles I'd try  
To purchase by my native wit! Yet what the subway "best"  
has writ  
In flaming words, with weird device—that make I mine,—  
and pay the price.

---

## TRIMMING

When your father, long ago, tried to train you—and you  
know  
    He thought mornings meant for school, and not for  
swimming—  
How your heart beat loud in dread as relentlessly he said,  
    "You'll *remember*—when you've had another trimming."

When your daughter buys a hat, and you're wondering  
thereat,  
    As before the glass she stands, its beauty hymning;  
Ah! the mischief in her eyes, as she pleads, "Show no  
surprise  
    At the *cost*. One has to pay for *pretty trimming*."

When the butcher brings your bill, and you stare at it until  
    Your tongue with fervid words is fairly brimming,  
Then you hear him meekly say, as your anger you display,  
    "It seems high, because there's so much *waste* in  
trimming."

So when politicians try your votes to beg or buy



With their sophistry—your common sense that's dimming  
—  
Just *remember* then the *cost* (and the *waste*, should all be  
lost),  
Of the smooth-tongued, wordy trimmer's *pretty trimming*.

---

## THE ANNEX

"Stone walls do not a prison make, nor iron bars a cage"  
High halls do not a College make, nor book-lined shelves a  
sage.  
So might I follow haltingly these olden words to show  
That even in this newer home the Annex may not know  
A greater zeal for learning than the old house could bestow.  
But comparisons are odious, so I'll merely try to say  
That cherished deep within the hearts of many here today  
Is the memory of that early home in the classic Appian Way.  
There first did the young Annex (whose real Christian name  
Contains as many syllables as it has liens on fame)  
Win laurels even brighter than its friends had hoped to  
claim.  
And there, too, in their search, for intellectual recreation  
Its students formed the short-lived *Appian Way Association*  
Of which this later Club is but an "Idler" imitation.  
Just where the interloper dwelt was long a mystery.  
In the past to Harvard students and to townsmen equally,  
Till they cried, "There is no Annex—believe we only what  
we see!"  
Now the Annex and its mission every year are better known,  
From the smallest of beginnings strong and powerful it has  
grown:  
Only Harvard Freshmen speak of it in supercilious tone,  
Although custom would forbid us as we are passing near,

To salute the ancient building with a rousing Annex cheer,  
We need no sign like this to prove that still we hold it dear.  
Now the students who have profited by their foreseeing care  
Fondly thank the Annex founders who knew not the word  
"despair."  
Its best home was the hearts of those who planned the  
structure fair.

*(Read at a College celebration.)*

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## *A LIBERTY BOND*

A liberty bond! What a queer contradiction!  
Although truth, as you've heard, may be stranger than  
fiction.  
For Liberty should from all fetters release us,  
While bonds hold one fast, whether pauper or Cræsus.  
Yet a Liberty Bond—I'd advise you to buy it—  
Will ensure you your freedom—you'll see when you try it.  
'Twill aid you to conquer foes cruel, despotic,  
'Twill help save your Country, come, be patriotic!  
A Liberty Bond—I'd advise you to buy one—  
Will ensure you your freedom—rejoice when you try one!

---

## *A HERO*

Like many another I have crossed  
Oftener than once the broad Atlantic,  
And—feeling qualms when tempest-tossed,

Have shuddered at the waves gigantic,  
Fearing that really nevermore  
I'd find myself again ashore.

Then when—upset—and scarce awake,  
In moments of perturbed reflection,  
My wandering thoughts would slowly take  
Time and again the same direction.  
I'd think of that adventurous man,  
Who crossed the sea—first of my clan.

'Tis not for me to hope to find  
Upon my family tree's broad branches  
Ancestors wholly to my mind;  
I know that I am taking chances  
In digging them up from the past  
To deck this hardy tree at last.

Indeed I would not waste my breath,  
And even less my ink and paper,  
To prove from Queen Elizabeth  
Is my descent (*some* cut this caper),  
Nor in King Alfred root my tree—  
Here's jocund genealogy.

A Governor or two, of course,—  
Or even a Colonial preacher  
I'd not despise,—nor yet perforce  
A good Selectman, stern of feature,  
Provided they came early here.  
Such ancestors to me are dear.

Yet of them all the man I hold  
A mighty hero—none seems greater—  
Is he—that honest man and bold—  
Whether Psalm-singer, or bear-baiter,  
First of my name to reach the strand,

Of this almost unpeopled land.

He may have been of high estate,  
He may have been a simple yeoman,  
Undaunted by an adverse fate,  
Brave was he as the bravest Roman.  
At naught he quailed, his heart was stout,  
When he for the New World set out.

Compared with mine—a little skiff  
His boat was, on the untracked ocean,  
Comforts were scarce, and breezes stiff—  
No luxuries,—though I've a notion  
Billows were just as high as now,  
While Danger sat upon the prow.

Just where would be his landing-place.  
He hardly knew when waves he tossed on  
While my woes at sea efface  
By merely murmuring, "Home is Boston."  
Yet he had left his all behind  
In the new world his all to find.

"R-E-E-D"—"E-I"—"E-A,"  
Just how we spell it need not matter.  
The name we honor here today  
Each clan may claim with equal clatter  
British, euphonious, clear and short,  
Rede me a name of better sort!

*Read at a meeting of a Genealogical Society.*

---

## *THE RIVALS*

Said the Bicycle to the Automobile:  
"How high and mighty and gay you feel;  
Yet I can remember the day when I  
Would let no other one pass me by  
Cart horse and roadster and racehorse too,  
Far ahead of them all I flew.  
Now my tires are unpumped and my warning bell  
The attention of nobody can compel.

"Though you maim your thousands where I hurt one,  
Though ten times my farthest is your day's run,  
Still I have been learning while lying here,  
That a rival's coming for you to fear.  
I have heard them talk of a wonderful thing,  
That can fly in the air like a bird on the wing,  
That can carry a man over land, over sea;  
In a twinkling he is where he wishes to be.

"So swiftly it speeds, in a week and a day  
One may girdle the globe, I have heard them say,  
While you are contented from dawn to dark  
With a few score miles to have made your mark."  
The giant, throughout his quivering frame,  
Felt the truth that was mixed with his rival's blame.  
"I'll never be such a clod as you,"  
He sputtered as off on the road he flew;  
And his end the Bicycle never knew.

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## FROM THE ODES OF HORACE

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*TO MÆCENAS. III-29*

Mæcenās, scion of Tyrrhenian rulers,  
A jar, as yet unpierced, of mellow wine  
Long waits thee here, with balm for thee made ready  
And blooming roses in thy locks to twine.

No more delay, nor always look with favor  
The sloping fields of Æsula upon;  
Why gaze so long on ever marshy Tibur  
Near by the mount of murderer Telegon?

Give up thy luxury—it palls upon thee—  
Thy tower that reaches yonder lofty cloud;  
Cease to admire the smoke, the wealth, the uproar,  
And all that well hath made our Rome so proud.

Sometimes a change is grateful to the rich man,  
A simple meal beneath a humble roof  
Has often smoothed from care the furrowed forehead,  
Though unadorned that home with purple woof.

Bright Cepheus now his long-hid fire is showing,  
Now flames on high the angry lion-star,  
Now Procyon rages, and the sun revolving  
Brings back the thirsty season from afar.

Seeking a cooling stream, the weary shepherd  
His languid flock leads to the shady wood  
Where rough Sylvanus reigns, yet by the brookside.  
No truant breeze disturbs the solitude.

Ah, who but thee is busy now with statecraft?  
Thou plannest for Rome's weal, disquieted,  
Lest warring Scythian, Bactrian, or Persian  
Should'st plunge the city into awful dread.

A prudent deity in pitchy darkness  
The issue of futurity conceals,  
And smiles when man beyond the right of mortals,  
His fear about the time to come reveals.

Thou should'st concern thee only with the present,  
All else progresses as the river flows,  
Which gliding at one time in middle channel  
Toward the Tuscan Sea unruffled goes;

Or at another time, herds, trees, and houses,  
And broken rocks to one destruction drags,  
When wild the flood provokes the quiet current  
With noise from neighboring woods and distant  
crag.

Happy he lives, and of himself is master,  
That man who can at night with truth declare,  
"I have lived to-day, to-morrow let the Father  
Make as he will my sky or dark or fair,

"It is not his to render vain and worthless  
My happy past—the bliss has dearer grown  
That the fleet-footed hour carried with it;  
The joys that once have been are still my own.

"Now upon me, again on others smiling,  
Fortune rejoices in her savage trade  
Of shifting thus at will uncertain honors,  
As stubbornly her mocking game is played.

"I praise her when she stays, but if she leave me,  
Fluttering her airy wings in hasty flight,  
I yield her what she gave, and wrapped in virtue,  
In dowerless Poverty find my delight.

"Although the mast may crack beneath the South

wind,  
I will not rush with many a doleful prayer  
To barter thus my vows, lest all my treasure  
From Tyre and Cyprus should become a share

"Of what the greedy sea has in possession;  
Nay! then, protected in my two-oared boat,  
With favoring winds, and with twin Pollux guiding  
Safe through the Ægean tempests I will float."

*(This version won, in 1890, the Sargent Prize, offered annually to students of Harvard University and Radcliffe College.)*

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## TO LEUCONOË. I-11

Seek not to learn—Leuconoë,—a mortal may not know—  
What term of life on you or me our deities bestow.  
The Babylonian soothsayer consult not; better bear  
Whatever comes, whether to you more winters Jove shall spare,  
Or whether this may be the last, grinding the Tuscan sea  
On yonder rocks. Even as we talk, time envious shall flee.  
Filter your wine, be wise, and clip your hopes to life's brief span.  
Then seize today; to-morrow trust as little as you can.

---

## TO NEOBULÉ. III-12



Ah! Unhappy are the maidens, who love's game are kept  
from playing,

Nor in mellow wine may wash away their cares;  
Who, scared by scolding uncles' tongues, their terror are  
displaying,—

But from you, though, Neobulé, Cupid bears  
Your basket and your webs, yet all the zeal you have been  
showing

For industrious Minerva, is the prey  
Of fair Hebrus, Liparæan, when his shoulders, oiled and  
glowing,

He has bathed in Tiber's waters. Let me say  
As a horseman, than Bellerophon he's really something  
greater;

Never worsted in a hand-fight, nor a race.  
Skilled to shoot the flying stag-herd in the open,—swift he  
later

Snares the boar, close-hidden in a shady place.

---

## *THE HARDY YOUTH. III-2*

The hardy youth, my friends, in bitter warfare

To narrow poverty must learn to bend,  
And, for his spear a horseman to be dreaded,  
Courageous Parthians into flight must send.

And he must try all dangerous adventures,

His life out in the open he must pass;  
The warring tyrant's wife and growing daughter

Him spying from their hostile walls, "Alas,"  
They sigh—for fear the royal husband,

Unskilled in warlike arts, should dare attack  
This lion, fierce to touch, whom bloody anger  
Into the midst of slaughter has dragged back.

'Tis sweet and fit to perish for one's country,  
Death follows fast upon the man who flees,  
Nor spares the coward backs of youth retreating,  
Nor saves them trembling on their timid knees,  
Valor, of shabby failure all unconscious,  
Gleams with untarnished honor where she stands,  
Assuming not, nor laying down her emblems,  
As now the gaping populace demands.  
Valor, when opening Heaven to those, who dying  
Deserve not death, by paths no other knows  
Points out the way, and still while she is soaring,  
Her scorn for crowds and humid earth she shows.  
And there's a sure reward for loyal silence.  
Him I'll forbid under my roof to sit  
Who has divulged the Elusinian mysteries,  
Nor in my fragile shallop shall he flit  
Often great Jupiter, when once neglected,  
The wicked near the innocent has put,  
But punishment to overtake the guilty  
Has rarely failed, though she is lame of foot

---

## *TO THE STATE. I-14*

Oh! Ship of State! fresh billows to sea will bear thee back,  
Then turn about and bravely toward the harbor tack,  
Thou see'st that thy naked sides defending oarsmen lack.

Behold! thy mast lies shattered before the swift south wind,  
Listen! the yards are creaking, the ropes no longer bind,  
Strength to endure the boisterous waves thy keel can hardly  
find.

Now all thy sails are ragged; the gods are swept away

To whom, borne down by peril, thy quaking soul would  
pray.

Though lofty be thy lineage, its pride is vain today.

The power and name thou boastest are now of no avail,  
Thy stern is gayly painted, and still thy seamen quail,  
Beware lest thou art made the sport of every idle gale.

Ah! dearly loved, my country; my fond yet heavy care!  
Thy discords lately wearied me, but now I breathe a prayer  
That thee the tides of faction, the glittering rocks may spare.

---

## *TO APOLLO. I-31*

What prays the poet of enshrined Apollo?

What is he asking for with lifted hands,  
Pouring a fresh libation from his flagon?—

Not fertile crop from rich Sardinian lands,—  
Not the fair herds of sultry, damp Calabria,—  
Not even Indian ivory and gold;—

Nor meadows that the Liris, silent river,  
With sluggish flow has nibbled, as it rolled.

Let those whom Fortune has endowed with vineyards,  
With the Calenian knife their grapevines trim,

Let the rich merchant from his golden goblet  
Drink wine by Syrian traffic bought for him.

Dear to the very gods he three times yearly,

Yes four times, travels the Atlantic Sea  
Unharm'd. But I—I feed myself on olives,  
Ay, succory and soft mallows are for me.

Let one enjoy sound health and my possessions—

Son of Latona, grant to me, I pray,

With a sane mind an old age all unsullied,  
Nor let my gift—my lyre—be taken away.

---

### *TO DIANA. III-22*

Diana, Protector of mountain and wood,  
Who when three times invoked, hast so well understood,  
And young mothers in child-birth hast rescued from death,  
Goddess, triply endowed!  
Let this tree overhanging my house here, this pine  
Be for thee, that each year I shall consecrate thine,  
Happy still—with the blood of a boar, whose last breath,  
Planned a side-long attack.

---

### *TO MELPOMENE. IV-3*

Oh, him whom at birth you with favor regarded  
Melpomene! never an Isthmian game  
Shall render renowned, though he's skilled as a boxer,  
Nor shall a swift horse lead him onward to fame.  
Though a victor he rides in a chariot Achaian,  
Not him shall the fortune of war ever show.  
In the Capitol wearing the garland of laurel  
Because the proud threatenings of kings he laid low.  
But every stream flowing over the country  
Fertile Tibur around, and so every grove  
With its thick-growing leaves shall ennoble the poet,  
In Æolian song he ennobled shall prove.

The offspring of Rome, that is Queen among cities,  
Me have deemed as a bard to be worthy a place  
In her glorious choir, and less and less keenly  
Already the sharp bite of Envy I trace.  
Oh—Pieris! oh Muse, who the sweet tone controllest  
Of the golden-tongued lyre, able too, to endow  
The dumb fishes as well, if it happen to please thee,  
With the notes of the swan, 'tis from thee it comes now,  
That I by the finger of those who are passing  
The Lord of our own Roman lyre am shown,  
For all inspiration, for all that is pleasing,  
If it happen to please, thou hast made it my own.

---

### *HORACE AND LYDIA. III-9*

"One time when I was pleasing to you, Lydia,  
And when no other youth, preferred to me,  
Your snowy neck could with his arms encircle,  
Then happier I than Persia's King may be."

"When of another you were less enamored,  
Nor ranked me after Chloe in your love,  
Then I, your Lydia, of wide reputation,  
Than Roman Ilia more renowned could prove."

"Now Thracian Chloe, skilled in mellow measures,  
And expert on the harp, holds me her slave,  
To die for her would never cause me terror,  
If her—my soul—the Fates alive would save."

"'Tis Calais, Ornytus' son, the Thurian,  
Who now consumes me with a mutual fire,  
Ah! death for him twice over would I suffer,

Would but the Fates not let the boy expire."

"What if our former love to us returning,  
Us in a stronger yoke should join again!  
Should I unbar the door to cast-off Lydia,  
And give up fair-haired Chloe, ah, what then?"

"Though he be lovelier than a constellation,  
Though lighter than a cork, my dear, are you,  
Than stormy Adriatic more uncertain,  
With you I'd love to live, die gladly, too."

---

## *TO CENSORINUS. IV-8*

With kindly thought I'd give, Oh Censorinus,  
Bowls and bronze vases pleasing to each friend;  
Tripods I'd offer, prizes of brave Grecians,  
And not the worst of gifts to you I'd send  
Were I, forsooth, rich in such artist's treasure  
As Scopas and Parrhasius could convey,  
This one in stone, and that in liquid color,  
Skilled here a man,—a god there to portray.  
But mine no power like this, nor does your spirit  
Or your affairs need luxuries so choice.  
Songs we can give, and on the gift set value,  
Songs we can give, and you in songs rejoice.  
Not marble carved with popular inscriptions  
Whereby the spirit and the life return  
After their death unto our upright leaders,  
Nor Hannibal's swift flight, nor threatenings stern  
Thrown back on him, nor flames from impious Carthage,  
Ever more clearly pointed out the praise  
Of him who, after Africa was conquered,

Acquired a name, than did the Calabrian lays.  
And you would lose, if writings should be silent,  
The price of all that you so well have done.  
And Romulus,—his fame had envy silenced—  
Where had he been—great Mars and Ilia's son?  
Æacus, rescued from the Stygian waters,  
The genius, the favor, and the tongue  
Of mighty bards sent to the blessed islands,  
He cannot die, whose praise the Muse has sung.  
The Muse can deify. So tireless Hercules  
In Jove's desired banquets has a share.  
And the Tyndaridæ's clear constellation  
Of ships wrecked in the lowest depths takes care,  
Liber, his brows adorned with living vine-leaf,  
Brings to good issue every honest prayer.

---

## *TO THALIARCHUS. I-9*

You see how our Soracte now is standing  
Hoary with heavy snow, and now its weight  
To bear the struggling woods are hardly able,  
And with the bitter cold the streams stagnate.  
The cold melt thou away, oh, Thaliarchus,  
By heaping logs upon thy fire, again  
Replenishing, and from a Sabine flagon  
Wine of a four years' vintage draw thou then.  
Leave to the gods the rest; for at the moment  
They felled the winds upon the boiling sea  
That battled fiercely, then there was not stirring  
Or mountain-ash, or ancient cypress tree.  
Cease thou to ask what is to be to-morrow,  
The day that Fortune gives, score thou as gain.  
As when a boy, thou shalt not scorn love's sweetness,

Nor smoothly moving dancers shalt disdain  
While crabbed age from thy fresh youth is distant.  
Now in the Field and in the Public Square  
All the soft whisperings that come at night-fall  
Shall at the trysting be repeated there.  
Now, too, the tempting laugh from a far corner  
That must the maiden lurking there betray!  
Also the pledge that she in feigned resistance,  
Lest from her arm or hand be taken away!

---

### *TO CHLOE. I-23*

Ah Chloe, like a fawn you now elude me,  
Seeking its timid dam on lonely hills,  
Its dam who not without an idle tremor  
At breezes in the forest thrills.  
For if before the breeze the bushes quiver  
With rustling leaves, or if green lizards start  
Across the bramble, then it is it trembles,—  
This little fawn—in knees and heart.  
But Chloe, I am not a cruel tiger,  
Nor a Gætulian lion, thee to chase;  
And now that thou art old enough to marry,  
Beside thy mother take thy place.

---

### *TO FUSCUS. I-22*



Oh, Fuscus, he whose life is pure and upright,  
Wants not the Moorish javelin nor the bow,  
Nor may he need the quiver, heavy laden  
With arrows poisoned for the lurking foe.  
Whether he is about to make a journey  
To sultry Libya, or the unfriendly height  
Of Caucasus, or to the distant places  
That famed Hydaspes washes in his flight.  
For lately me a wolf fled in the forest—  
The Sabine forest, as my Lalage  
I sang about,—beyond my boundaries wandering,  
Care-free, unarmed—the creature fled from me.  
Apulia, land of soldiers, never nourished  
In her broad woods a monster of such girth,  
Nor Mauritania, arid nurse of lions,  
To such a one has ever given birth.  
Ah, put me on those plains, remote and barren,  
Where not a tree can feel the summer wind,  
And grow again—a land of mist eternal—  
Whereover Jupiter still broods, unkind;  
Or place me in that land denied man's dwelling,  
Too near the chariot of the sun above,—  
Still my own Lalage so sweetly smiling,  
My sweetly-speaking Lalage I'll love.

---

### *TO VENUS. III-26*

Lately was I to gentle maidens suited,  
And not without some glory did contend,  
But now my weapons and my lute made useless  
For contests, on this wall I will suspend,  
That guards the left side of our sea-born Venus;  
Here, here, place you my gleaming waxen torch,

My levers and my crow-bars that can threaten  
The doors that ought to open on this porch.  
Oh, Goddess, thou who blessed Cyprus rulest,  
And Memphis ever lacking Thracian snow,  
My Queen, in passing, with thy whip uplifted  
Give to my haughty Chloe just one blow.

---

## *A PALINODE. I-16*

Oh, daughter, lovelier than your lovely mother,  
Whatever punishment you may desire  
Give my offending verses; in the fire  
Throw them, please you, or in the Adriatic.  
Not Dindymene, no, nor even Apollo  
So shakes the minds of priests within the shrine;  
Nor so disturbing is the God of wine,  
Nor Corybantes doubling their shrill cymbals,  
As direful fits of anger that are frightened  
Neither by Noric sword nor savage flame,  
Nor by ship-wrecking seas, nor them can tame  
Great Jupiter himself, with all his thunders.  
To our original clay, they say Prometheus  
Was forced to add a portion he had made  
Of bits from every creature, and he laid  
In human hearts rage from the furious lion.  
With crushing ruin rage destroyed Thyestes;  
And as a final cause rage may be known  
Why mighty cities fell, quite overthrown,  
And why upon their walls a sneering army  
Its plowshare drags along. But keep your temper!  
Me, too in my sweet youth a frenzied heart  
Has tempted sorely, and its maddening dart  
Has driven me to write impetuous verses

To change sad things for brighter I am seeking,  
And since my offending verses I retract,  
I beg of you in turn a friendly act,  
That you again to me your heart give over.

---

### *LASTING FAME. III-30*

A monument outlasting brass I have builded,  
Higher than pyramids in their crumbling glory,  
That no devouring storm, nor futile North wind  
Can overthrow, nor years in long succession,  
Nor fleeting seasons. I shall not wholly perish.  
In great part I'll escape the funeral pyre;  
And lately praised, my praise will go on growing  
To latest years. As long as Priest and Vestal  
Ascend the Capitol, I shall be mentioned  
Where Aufidus fierce rages, and where Daunus  
A rustic race rules in an arid country.  
Great, though of humble birth, I the first poet  
To write in Latin rhythms Æolian lyrics,  
Take pride, Melpomene, in well-earned merits,  
And crown me willingly with Delphic laurel.

---

### *RELIGION. I-34*

God's mean and careless servant—while I wander  
Deep in the madness of Philosophy,—  
Now backward I must set my sail, and ponder

Where my forsaken course retraced shall be.  
For Jupiter, who with his glittering fire  
So often cleaves apart the threatening clouds,  
His wingèd car and thundering horses higher  
Toward air has driven where no shadow shrouds.

Whereat the sluggish earth, each vagrant river,—  
The Styx, and hated Tænarus' dread abode,  
And the Atlantic borders shake and shiver.  
Ah—to reverse high things and low, our God  
Is able, and the mighty he can lower,  
The obscure can raise. From this man Fortune steals  
The crown to give to that one;—in her power,  
Showing with hissing wings the joy she feels.

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## TRANSCRIBER'S NOTES:

Inconsistencies in spelling and hyphenation have been retained from the original.

Inconsistencies between the poem titles in the Table of Contents and the titles of the poems in the text have been retained from the original except:

*The Raven* in the Table of Contents changed to *The Rover*

Obvious typographical errors have been corrected as follows:

Page 32: *Rememeber* changed to *Remember*

Page 37: *everything* changed to *everything*

\*\*\* END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK MEMORIAL DAY,  
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